

The Frenemies

MAY 10, 2010

The Congress may have outplayed a divided Opposition in Parliament but the victory only highlights the paralysis of governance and time for Manmohan Singh and Sonia Gandhi to assert their political authority.



“Indian politics is full of drama with friends turning foes and vice-versa. It has, however, made the job of voters easier as whosoever one chooses is not likely to have moral character.”

RAVINDRA MISRA, *Delhi*

Friendly Foes

The lead article by Prabhu Chawla is an advisory-cum-warning for UPA II against its so-called 'tactless' governance ("The Cost of Compromise", May 10). The UPA has survived the Opposition Cut Motion with the help of unreliable allies like the BSP, JMM and, of course, the well-christened foxy Yadav kingpins in the House. The article is an awesome story of political truth in Union governance at present as after weathering the motion the Manmohan Singh Government has been virtually robbed of its conviction and confidence and might face embarrassment on several unforeseen proceedings in the future.

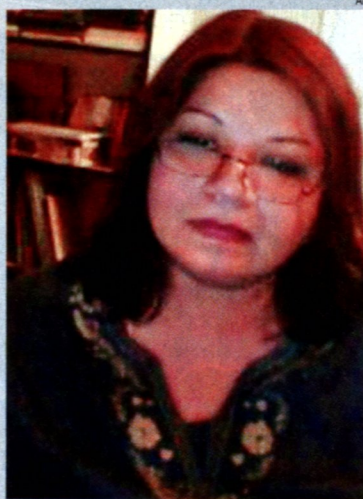
RAMESH SINHA, *Delhi*

The UPA Government's victory has come at a great

Enemy Within

The spy scandal involving Madhuri Gupta and her modus operandi appear to be strange because one cannot understand as to how one can stoop so low against the country ("Sleeping with the Enemy", May 10). She should be punished, but it is also a case for study.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,
Thiruvananthapuram



The reprehensible Madhuri Gupta episode has put the entire bureaucratic and intelligence system under suspicion, and has also raised a renewed threat to national security. It raises the question as to what makes officials spy on their own country. A rigorous analysis should be done to ascertain the reason. This has happened off and on and indicates the laxity of the system and the inadequacy of the punitive measures. In the present situation, the Government must award exemplary punishment, which would serve as a deterrent to anti-nationals.

INDU SHANKAR, *Varanasi*

moral cost and has only exposed the chinks in its armour. To all intents and purposes, the UPA is now a minority government, depending on mavericks like Mayawati for survival. True, Pranab Mukherjee displayed masterly finesse in saving the Government, but the manner in which the Congress misused the CBI to win over the SP, RJD and BSP shows how compromised and corrupt the Congress has become.

KANGAYAM R. NARASIMHAN,
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How strange it is that both Mayawati and Mulayam Singh Yadav ended up on same side during the Cut Motion. It shows that in politics anything is possible and people can turn sides on the spur of the moment. And if Manmohan Singh is forced to

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